

PREMISE DELTA v0.5 (THE TRUSTING FORGERY, THIRD CUT): DISPOSITION • 2026-09-11

Third round. Two independent adversaries attacked the same frozen text of four-keys-premise-delta-trusting-forgery-v0.5-2026-09-09.md, told to attack the answers of the two previous rounds. Fable: REWORK, high confidence, "the device itself ... I could not break on its own terms" (...-v0.5-attack-fable-2026-09-11.md). GPT: REWORK, high confidence (...-v0.5-attack-chatgpt-2026-09-11.md). Findings merged in order of fatality with my concurrence and a provisional in-world answer. Walked with Stephen one row at a time; the Status column records his ruling. v8.1 remains in force.

Where the two converge, and what it means

For the third time both adversaries hit the same joint: **what Margo knows about the money before Day 14, and what the world does with it**. Each round I have moved Margo's arrival later and thinner, and each round the adversaries have shown that she already holds everything on Day 8 and Day 19 and that a competent world asks her about it. The lesson is not that Margo needs another reason for silence. It is that **the money should not be a secret at all**. The second convergence is the **two glasses**, which both adversaries call the author's device rather than Brad's error, and they are right: they are canon from v1.4 and nobody had asked. The third is the **sister's path to the store through the business books**. All three are structural, all three are answerable, and one of them (the money) changes the shape of Margo's lock for the better.

The table

#	Finding	Fable	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
1	Margo and the money before Day 14. Fable: Violet's own kept instruction ("write down everything odd about each other") obliges Margo to list the debt, the calling-in and the missing book on Day 19; the Day 45 call adds no fact. GPT: on the Day 45 call the accountant's next question is the missing book Margo herself reported on Day 8, and "nothing in the books" is then concealment.	Fatal; the driver	Fatal; the driver	Yes, and to the pattern. Three rounds have failed to give Margo a reason to hide money that a competent world keeps asking her about.	The van loan is not a secret and never was. Violet set Brad up, van and first stock, eight years ago, and all four know it; Liam heard him price the van from the crane cab because it was Vi's money. What was private was only the calling-in this autumn (told to Brad on Day –110, to Margo on Day –120, and to the café in passing). On Day 19 Margo lists it as Violet asked: Vi was calling in the van money this autumn, for the lawyer. Brad confirms it at once and adds what nobody can check: he had been paying her back in cash since October, half of it, and would like the rest to go to the estate. A man who volunteers his own debt at a table looking for a liar is the last man the table suspects, and the letter's odd things are about someone else. Around Day 45 the sister's accountant, who has the missing book from Margo's own Day 8 report, rings; Margo answers everything truthfully: Violet's private loan book, the van loan, called in this autumn, Brad says half repaid. The accountant writes to Brad. Brad settles the balance he named, promptly, in cash. That is the arrival: the estate is satisfied, the sister is satisfied, and Margo alone knows that the one record that could have tested "half repaid" vanished from a locked house the night Violet died, and that the man who set his own number is the man defending Liam. Her reading is a reading; her reasons for silence are the world's (an innocent man also settles promptly; the book is gone; an absence is not evidence; he is the one arguing for the man the room has chosen); and it costs her exactly what the lock needs. Brad's motive sharpens rather than weakens: killing her and taking the book let him set the number.	Accepted 09-11

#	Finding	Fable	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
2	The two glasses. Both: Brad's own method removes his glass; if the police bagged them, the proper look after Day 60 finds his prints and closes on Brad before Ally; if not, someone washed them. The room's bridge from fall to killing then goes. GPT: the man in the lane is the outsider the audit misses, and a visitor Violet let in needs no key.	Serious, fatal if bagged	Fatal (front 6) and fatal (front 2)	Yes. The glasses are v1.4 canon, unasked for three rounds; the adversaries are right that they are the author's.	Brad rinses his glass and puts it on the rack with the others; one glass on the side, hers. The Day 1 scene reads as it always did minus one word. The room's bridge from fall to killing is rebuilt on what the world leaves: the man's back in the lane at 22:30 (Nº14 told the police on Day 1, who noted an unidentified male with nothing to identify him against, which is canon, and told Liam at the funeral); the back door latched from inside, which Liam, who fitted it, knows means only that someone pulled it shut behind him; and one fact about Violet that all four know and the police could not weigh: she did not open her door after dark to anyone she had not known for years. So the man in the lane either let himself in with the spare or was let in, and both mean one of a handful of people. That is how the man in the lane closes the pool instead of opening it: not by the key, by her habits. Her sentence about the spare then does its work beside her clearance as before.	Accepted 09-11
3	The sister's path to the store. Both: if the prepaid rent is in the business books, Margo handed the sister the store on Day 8 and an administrator opens it with a locksmith through the keyway, nothing visibly wrong. The delta never says how the sister reached it for Day 82.	Serious	Fatal as drafted	Yes. One unstated fact.	The store is where the loan was: off the books by Violet's choice. She paid the market manager a year in cash from the barrel with no receipt, as she paid for everything she did not want on paper, and it never entered the books Margo kept. The four know the store exists and tell the sister nothing (they are not helping her inventory anything). The sister reaches it on Day 82 by the route the story already wants: after Brad vanishes, Ruby decides the sister should have her mother back, tells her Violet had locked her in her store at the sheds, and hands her the tube; the sister has the empty store's padlock cut the same week to see what else her sister kept from her. Nothing else is there. Ally later gets the ashes from the sister, bitterly, in chapter 3, and the survivors still will not speak of them. (The alternative, the market manager finding her, is weaker and later.) Ruled: Ruby's route.	Accepted 09-11

#	Finding	Fable	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
4	Violet shows Brad, then what. GPT: a competent Violet secures the panel and keeps asking; a competent Brad retrieves or destroys it while he has access. Fable: who else buys leaf and size; the trade holds a pre-death witness.	Serious	Serious	Partly. Canon C2 already has Brad unable to search her without showing his hand (row –6); the delta failed to date the showing.	She shows him the day she locks it away: at the sheds, on Day –19, the panel under her arm on its way into the store, and the new padlock going on the door in front of him. He says yours, names the R, and watches her lock it in. From that hour he knows exactly where it is and that he cannot reach it, which is why he reads her book on Day 0 for the keys and not for the panel. She stops asking because she has done the thing she does with everything: written it down and locked it up for after. Leaf and size come by post to his flat, one line. The trade as witnesses to the police: the proper look (Days 222 to 262) is a review of three deaths and five letters, not of a panel nobody reported missing; the two signwriters are asked nothing because nobody knows to ask them until Ally airs the trade in chapter 6.	Accepted 09-11
5	The Day 14 sink. Fable: two hours and a fire in the dead woman's kitchen at noon under N ^o 14's window.	Serious	(not raised)	Yes. My Day 14 kept v8.1's bench and sink out of habit.	He conforms the draft at his own bench, on her paper with her pen taken from the workshop on Day 0 with the book, and burns the drafts, the true letter and the book in his own grate. He is never in her house after 22:30 on Day 0. The store is the only place he goes on Day 14, twice: at 07:20 to read and take, at about 14:00 to leave the forgery and her mother; his own locker is his reason both times.	Accepted 09-11
6	Manufacturer's keys (Fable, cosmetic).	Cosmetic	(not raised)	Yes.	Her book records it: the packet's two keys went off the end of the slip the day the four were cut. Brad reads that on Day 0.	Accepted 09-11
7	The solicitor's papers to the administrator (Fable): the sister knows by Day 15 that four friends received letters.	Serious (in the list of six)	(not raised)	Partly.	The Civic Row solicitor was Violet's against the sister; he holds his own file and volunteers nothing to the other side's solicitor beyond what the administration requires. If asked, he confirms he posted four sealed envelopes per instruction and does not know their contents. If the sister then asks the four, they say Violet left them keys to her store. Not an ender on any branch.	Accepted 09-11
8	The room never asks the sheds (Fable).	Serious with front 6	(not raised)	Yes that it needs a reason on the page.	Nobody in the room suspects the letter. They suspect the house. The store is where Violet put things; nobody imagines anyone else touched it, and the letter in her hand is the reason. No tampering hypothesis, no sheds question, which is the same R27 logic that keeps Del away from the sheds. Ruby, driving from Day 40, is driving at Liam and the back bedroom.	Accepted 09-11
9	Liam asks Brad where the van money came from (Fable).	Serious (in the list of six)	(not raised)	Answered by row 1.	Everyone knows: Vi lent it.	Accepted 09-11
10	The first minute	(not raised this round)	(not raised)	Held as a test.	Unchanged.	Held

What this round adds to the world regardless of premise

One glass, not two (v1.4 row 101 changes). The van loan known to all four; only the calling-in private. The store off the books; how the sister reaches it. The showing of the panel dated to the day it is locked away. Brad never in her house after Day 0. The packet keys off the slip.

Outcome of the walk, 2026-09-11

All nine substantive rows accepted; row 10 stays a reader test. The structural changes of this round: the van loan is open knowledge and only the calling-in was private; Brad confirms his debt at meeting one and claims half repaid; the estate is paid and that settlement is Margo's arrival; one glass, not two, and the room's bridge is the lane, the latch and her habits; the store off the books, and Ruby hands the sister the ashes after Brad vanishes; the panel shown to Brad at the store door on Day -19; Brad never in her house after Day 0.

Assembled as **delta vo.6** (four-keys-premise-delta-trusting-forgery-v0.6-2026-09-11.md, DRAFT until Stephen has read it) for a fourth round. v8.1 remains in force.

Provisional verdict, before the walk (kept for the record)

Both adversaries again returned REWORK, and Fable again says it cannot break the device. The convergent driver has been the same joint three times, and this round's answer removes the joint rather than reinforcing it: the money stops being a secret, Brad tells the room his own debt, the estate is paid, and Margo's silence is about a missing book and a number a dead woman can no longer dispute. The two glasses were the story's error, not the premise's, and go. The rest is one-line repair. That is my hypothesis; the walk is the check, and Stephen rules each row.